

Classroom SEL pack, a week on honesty, ages 3 to 7

The Honest Little Raccoon

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 The bakery choice	Act out the bakery scene. Stop at the moment the baker asks ‘Who made this mess?’ Let children try two endings: hiding, and owning up. Talk about how each ending felt.	Page 8
Day 5 Light and heavy	Light and heavy, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Belonging and Contributing, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a toy tray and play-dough rolls, a paper door, sticky notes

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What kind of animal is this? Where does he live? What do you think he gets up to at night? Ask: Is it ever hard to tell the truth? Why? Take a few answers kindly. Teach Maggie's words with a gesture: hand on heart, then arms wide. 'Truth will always set you free.'

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
5	Maggie: 'Truth will always set you free.'	What did Maggie tell Riley about the truth?	it stays with you, it sets you free, it opens doors
6	Benny is big and always protects Riley.	What kind of friend is Benny?	strong, kind, protective
8	They climb in and nibble the sweet rolls.	Was it okay for them to go into the bakery? Why or why not?	no, it wasn't theirs, they didn't ask
9	CRASH! The tray falls.	How do you think Riley feels right now?	scared, shocked, worried
10	Benny offers to take the blame.	Why do you think Benny offered to take the blame?	he wanted to protect Riley, he is bigger
11	Riley's heart pounds; he remembers Maggie.	What choice does Riley have to make?	run away or tell the truth
13	The baker sees the honesty in Riley's eyes.	What did the baker do when Riley was honest?	called him brave, said ask next time
14	Riley feels lighter, even proud.	How did Riley feel after telling the truth?	light, proud, free, happy

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don't need every stop.

Handle with care: Honesty is not about avoiding punishment. When a child owns up in class, respond as the baker did: with kindness. More notes on the "For every child" page.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

truth

what really happened

Do it: put your hand flat on your heart

blame

saying who did something wrong

Do it: point a finger, then drop it

admit

to say ‘I did it’

Do it: point to yourself

sorry

a word that shows you feel bad about what you did

Do it: rub a circle on your chest

free

light, not stuck or trapped

Do it: fling your arms open

Truth will always set you free.

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca



Lying only traps you in more lies. The truth sets you free.

Truth will always set you free.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



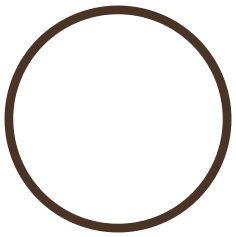
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

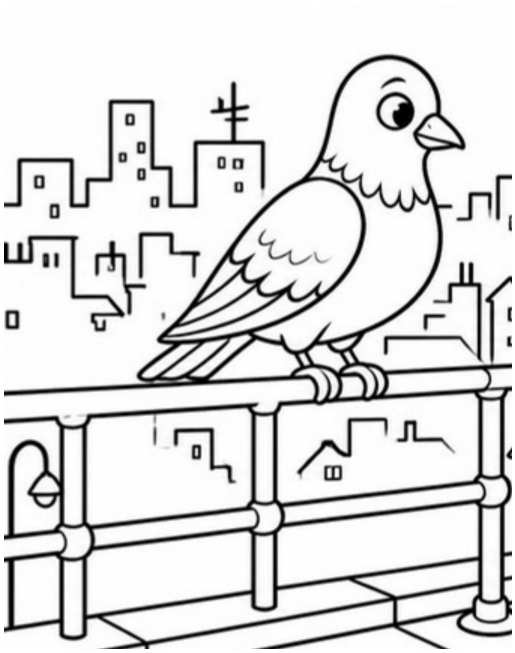
clip your name here

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

The bakery choice

10 minutes, Small groups, Materials: A toy tray, play-dough rolls

Act out the bakery scene. Stop at the moment the baker asks ‘Who made this mess?’ Let children try two endings: hiding, and owning up. Talk about how each ending felt.

Light and heavy

5 minutes, Whole class, Materials: None

Hunch your shoulders like you’re carrying a secret. Then say ‘It was me, I’m sorry’ and let your shoulders drop and your arms fly open. Talk about the difference.

Doors that truth opens

15 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A big paper door, sticky notes

On sticky notes, children draw or say good things that can happen after telling the truth (a friend forgives, a grown-up helps, you feel light). Stick them on the paper door.

Science and nature corner

Raccoons come from North America, including southern Canada. They are mostly awake at night, have clever front paws that they use like hands, and have learned to live in cities, in attics, parks and sewers. Their black mask and ringed tail make them easy to spot. City pigeons come from wild rock doves and are famous for finding their way home. Real raccoons can carry germs: never touch or feed one.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. What did Maggie tell Riley about the truth?

Look for: That the truth stays with you and sets you free, even when it's hard.

2. Why do you think Benny offered to take the blame?

Look for: He wanted to protect his friend.

3. How did Riley feel before he told the truth? And afterwards?

Look for: Scared, heart pounding before; light and proud after.

4. What did the baker do when Riley was honest?

Look for: He said Riley was brave and told them to ask next time.

5. Can you remember a time when telling the truth was hard?

Look for: Any answer. Thank children for sharing.



Say it together

Truth will always set you free.

The big idea: Telling the truth can feel scary, but it makes your heart feel light and helps people trust you.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show honesty this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show honesty by

Name _____



I can show honesty by

Name _____



I can show honesty by

Name _____



I can show honesty by

Name _____

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Belonging and Contributing	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Science and place corner

The book's city has no name, so we picked Central Park in New York City. Raccoons and pigeons both live there, right in the middle of a big city.



Raccoon

In parts of Europe and Asia, people call the raccoon a 'wash-bear'.



Raccoon

Raccoons walk on flat feet, just like we do.



Rock pigeon

Homing pigeons have flown over 480 km in one day, at about 70 km/h.

Central Park, New York City

Riley: Real raccoons can't talk or make promises, but they really are curious and clever with their hands, which is why they get into everything.

Benny: Grown-up raccoons mostly live alone, so best friends are a story idea. Young raccoons do stay with their mother and brothers and sisters for a while.

Maggie: A pigeon that lives to old age in a city has seen a lot! Wild pigeons usually live 3 to 5 years, but some live much longer.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-honest-little-raccoon

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Teach two short sentences: ‘It was me’ and ‘I’m sorry’, with gestures. Use them in the bakery role play.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 5, 10 and 14). This book has 17 spreads with short text on each, so it reads quickly.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children talk about Benny’s offer: was it kind? Was it right? What would a good friend do?

Handle with care

Honesty is not about avoiding punishment. When a child owns up in class, respond as the baker did: with kindness.

Sneaking into the bakery was the mistake. Don’t frame it as a fun adventure to copy.

Real-life safety: never approach, touch or feed wild animals like raccoons.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. All over the world, families tell children stories about owning up to a mistake, and how honesty, even when it is hard, opens doors.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Honest Little Raccoon, a story about telling the truth. Riley the raccoon makes a mess in a bakery, and even when his friend offers to take the blame, he steps forward and says, 'It was me. I'm sorry.' At home, when your child owns up to something, thank them first, then talk about how to fix it. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Petit Raton Laveur Honnête, une histoire sur la vérité. Riley le raton laveur fait un désordre dans une boulangerie et, même quand son ami propose de prendre la faute, il s'avance et dit : « C'est moi. Je suis désolé. » À la maison, quand votre enfant avoue quelque chose, remerciez-le d'abord, puis parlez ensemble de la façon de réparer. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre decir la verdad. Riley, el mapache, hace un desastre en una panadería y, aunque su amigo se ofrece a cargar con la culpa, da un paso adelante y dice: «Fui yo. Lo siento». En casa, cuando su hijo o hija admita algo, agradézcale primero y luego hablen de cómo arreglarlo. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über die Wahrheit gelesen. Der Waschbär Riley macht in einer Bäckerei Unordnung, und obwohl sein Freund die Schuld auf sich nehmen will, tritt er vor und sagt: ‚Ich war es. Es tut mir leid.' Wenn Ihr Kind zu Hause etwas zugibt, danken Sie ihm zuerst und sprechen Sie dann darüber, wie man es wiedergutmacht. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul dire la verità. Riley, il procione, combina un pasticcio in una panetteria e, anche quando il suo amico si offre di prendersi la colpa, si fa avanti e dice: «Sono stato io. Mi dispiace». A casa, quando vostro figlio o vostra figlia ammette qualcosa, ringraziatelo prima, poi parlate insieme di come rimediare. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Honesty: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Honesty: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Honesty: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Honesty: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca



Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Honest Little Raccoon

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: honesty.

For use in your own home. Please don’t share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Telling the truth can feel scary, but it makes your heart feel light and helps people trust you.

Say it together

Truth will always set you free.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
truth	what really happened	put your hand flat on your heart
blame	saying who did something wrong	point a finger, then drop it
admit	to say ‘I did it’	point to yourself
sorry	a word that shows you feel bad about what you did	rub a circle on your chest
free	light, not stuck or trapped	fling your arms open

A gentle note

Sneaking into the bakery was the mistake. Don’t frame it as a fun adventure to copy.

Real-life safety: never approach, touch or feed wild animals like raccoons.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Riley

Raccoon

A young raccoon learning that telling the truth is brave



Benny

Raccoon

Riley's friend



Maggie

Rock pigeon

The wise old pigeon

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

How did they feel?

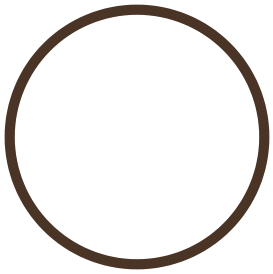
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Maggie: ‘Truth will always set you free.’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

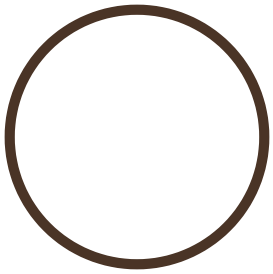


Moment 2

Benny offers to take the blame.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

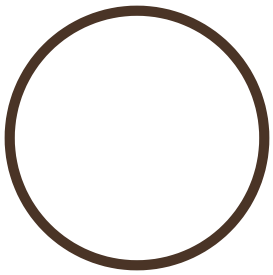


Moment 3

Riley feels lighter, even proud.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

truth what really happened

truth truth

blame saying who did something wrong

blame blame

admit to say ‘I did it’

admit admit

Riley the hero of the story

Riley Riley

Write your name

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Draw your own story

Riley showed honesty. Draw a time when you showed honesty too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

The bakery choice

You need: A toy tray, play-dough rolls

Act out the bakery scene. Stop at the moment the baker asks ‘Who made this mess?’ Let children try two endings: hiding, and owning up. Talk about how each ending felt.

Truth jar

Each time someone tells a hard truth, drop a button in a jar. Count them at the end of the week.

Mystery bag

Put a few things in a bag. Can you tell what they are just by feeling, like a raccoon?

Find your way home

Draw a map from your bed to the kitchen. Can someone follow it, like a homing pigeon?

Draw what you made

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

The real animals

The animals in The Honest Little Raccoon are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Riley

Raccoon

In parts of Europe and Asia, people call the raccoon a 'wash-bear'.



Benny

Raccoon

Raccoons walk on flat feet, just like we do.



Maggie

Rock pigeon

Homing pigeons have flown over 480 km in one day, at about 70 km/h.

Story or real?

Real raccoons can't talk or make promises, but they really are curious and clever with their hands, which is why they get into everything.

Where they really live

The book's city has no name, so we picked Central Park in New York City. Raccoons and pigeons both live there, right in the middle of a big city.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-honest-little-raccoon

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What kind of animal is this? Where does he live? What do you think he gets up to at night?

The Honest Little Raccoon, talk card 1

What did Maggie tell Riley about the truth?

The Honest Little Raccoon, talk card 2

Why do you think Benny offered to take the blame?

The Honest Little Raccoon, talk card 3

How did Riley feel before he told the truth? And afterwards?

The Honest Little Raccoon, talk card 4

What did the baker do when Riley was honest?

The Honest Little Raccoon, talk card 5

Can you remember a time when telling the truth was hard?

The Honest Little Raccoon, talk card 6

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca



Honesty hero

This is to say that

_____

showed honesty, just like Riley.

Truth will always set you free.

_____ _____

Signed Date

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca